

Blister - Foot and Hand - Male (Adult)

Algorithm 1421 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Male

Definition

- Foot and hand blister assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published blister guidance.
- Adult patient.
- Male.

Initial assessment

1. [LOCATION] Where is the blister?
2. [OPEN_TEXT] What caused it?
3. [YES_NO] Any redness, pus, or increasing pain?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Burns - Thermal

Did the blister form directly after a heat, hot-liquid, or flame burn?

A blister caused by thermal injury belongs in the Burns - Thermal pathway.

1. Disposition level 70

Is the blister severely painful or recurring, does the surrounding skin look hot and infected with green/yellow pus, is there spreading redness, is it in an unusual location (eyelid, mouth, genitals), are there multiple blisters without a clear cause, or did it result from a burn, scald, sunburn, or allergic reaction?

NHS.UK blister guidance lists these as reasons to seek prompt clinical review.

1. Disposition level 15

Is this a typical friction blister from new shoes or repeated rubbing, with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance describes typical friction blisters as manageable at home.

Advice

Urgent in-person blister review

- Arrange same-day in-person assessment through the Qatar route approved by governance for spreading redness, warmth, pus, fever, severe pain, a burn/chemical/electrical/frostbite cause, widespread or unexplained blistering, or any blister in a person with diabetes, poor circulation, neuropathy, or immunocompromise. Do not burst or peel it and do not apply unprescribed chemicals.
- Call Back If: spreading redness, pus, or fever; rapidly increasing pain or blistering; high-risk cause or health condition.

Home care for a typical blister

- Keep the blister clean, gently wash and pat dry, and cover with a soft plaster or padded dressing. Do not burst it yourself; if it bursts on its own, let the fluid drain before covering, and don't peel off the skin. Avoid the shoes or activity that caused it until healed.
- Call Back If: signs of infection develop; pain worsens.

First aid

References

- NHS.UK, "Blisters", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/blisters/> (page last reviewed 22 November 2023)

Provenance

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